

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Liberalism and Neoliberalism - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Liberalism and Neoliberalism

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

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Proposition Discipline, Sources and Final Integration

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Liberalism and Neoliberalism - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g3 **PYQ ownership:** Every verified question below retains the primary owner recorded in the source ledger.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Authoritarian state**?

A. A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge (Gaubu, PDF p.40). B. Liberalism opposes unquestioned and arbitrary authority and demands limits on power plus rights for individuals (Gaubu, PDF pp.40-41). C. Hayek and Friedman chiefly defend market coordination and limits on welfare intervention; Nozick grounds a minimal state in self-ownership and entitlement. The labels may overlap in Gauba, but the arguments should not be treated as interchangeable. D. Adds a moral dimension and advances a fuller theory of welfare liberalism (Gaubu, PDF p.41).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Authoritarian state** with **A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge (Gaubu, PDF p.40)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge (Gaubu, PDF p.40)**.

A. Hobhouse / Laski / Tawney B. Authoritarian state C. "Examine"/"Critically examine" D. Welfare / positive liberalism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge (Gaubu, PDF p.40)** with **Authoritarian state**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Classical / negative liberalism**?

A. Classical liberalism wants minimal state interference; welfare liberalism wants positive state action for dignity and welfare (Gaubu, PDF pp.41-42). B. Father of liberalism; early defender of rights, consent and limited government within classical liberalism (Gaubu, PDF p.41). C. The laissez-faire strand that confines the state to protection of life, property, contract and minimal common services (Gaubu, PDF p.41). D. Develop the welfare-state tradition in the first half of the twentieth century (Gaubu, PDF p.41).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Classical / negative liberalism** with **The laissez-faire strand that confines the state to protection of life, property, contract and minimal common services (Gaubu, PDF p.41)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **The laissez-faire strand that confines the state to protection of life, property, contract and minimal common services (Gaubu, PDF p.41)**.

A. Hayek / Friedman / Nozick B. "Critically evaluate" C. Welfare state D. Classical / negative liberalism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **The laissez-faire strand that confines the state to protection of life, property, contract and minimal common services (Gaubu, PDF p.41).** with **Classical / negative liberalism.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Welfare / positive liberalism**?

A. The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development (Gaubu, PDF p.41). B. Welfare liberalism expands state responsibility; neoliberalism wants to roll back intervention and restore laissez-faire individualism (Gaubu, PDF pp.42-43). C. Early liberal defender of laissez-faire and market society (Gaubu, PDF pp.41-42). D. Chief exponents of neoliberal or libertarian rollback against the welfare state (Gaubu, PDF p.42).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Welfare / positive liberalism** with **The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development (Gaubu, PDF p.41).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development (Gaubu, PDF p.41).**

A. Knowledge argument B. Welfare / positive liberalism C. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20) D. Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development (Gaubu, PDF p.41).** with **Welfare / positive liberalism.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Welfare state**?

A. Early liberal thought develops both through rights-bearing individualism and through happiness-maximizing utilitarianism, though Mill pulls utilitarianism toward liberty and welfare reform (Gaubu, PDF p.42). B. Founder of utilitarianism, focused on greatest happiness, but still part of early liberal development (Gaubu, PDF pp.41-42). C. A state that provides social security, education, health and other public services to secure social well-being (Gaubu, PDF p.41). D. neoliberalism holds that governments cannot possess sufficient knowledge of dispersed individual needs and circumstances to plan an economy successfully; needs and coordination emerge instead through unpredictable transactions in a free market ("spontaneous order"), not through centralized state knowledge (Gaubu, PDF pp.42-43).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Welfare state** with **A state that provides social security, education, health and other public services to secure social well-being (Gaubu, PDF p.41).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A state that provides social security, education, health and other public services to secure social well-being (Gaubu, PDF p.41).**

A. Price/market-coordination argument B. Authoritarian state C. Liberalism vs authoritarianism D. Welfare state

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A state that provides social security, education, health and other public services to secure social well-being (Gauba, PDF p.41).** with **Welfare state**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism**?

A. Gauba groups these closely as a restoration of laissez-faire and welfare-state rollback (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43). For conceptual precision, market neoliberalism (Hayek/Friedman) and rights-based libertarianism (Nozick) overlap but are not identical. B. Gauba says liberalism today is invoked both as a theory of capitalism and as a theory of constitutionalism; the second has more lasting political value (Gauba, PDF p.45). C. Modifies utilitarianism, elevates liberty, and opens the road toward taxation for welfare and a positive state role (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42). D. the neoliberal claim is that decentralized market exchange coordinates dispersed knowledge and choices more effectively than central planning, and Gauba reports the further neoliberal claim that markets maximize choice and can even serve as a model of genuine "democracy" in the economic sphere (Gauba, PDF p.43).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism** with **Gauba groups these closely as a restoration of laissez-faire and welfare-state rollback (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).** For conceptual precision, market neoliberalism (Hayek/Friedman) and rights-based libertarianism (Nozick) overlap but are not identical.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gauba groups these closely as a restoration of laissez-faire and welfare-state rollback (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43). For conceptual precision, market neoliberalism (Hayek/Friedman) and rights-based libertarianism (Nozick) overlap but are not identical.**

A. Coercion argument B. Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism C. Classical / negative liberalism D. Classical vs welfare liberalism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba groups these closely as a restoration of laissez-faire and welfare-state rollback (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43). For conceptual precision, market neoliberalism (Hayek/Friedman) and rights-based libertarianism (Nozick) overlap but are not identical.** with **Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Liberalism vs authoritarianism**?

A. Hayek and Friedman chiefly defend market coordination and limits on welfare intervention; Nozick grounds a minimal state in self-ownership and entitlement. The labels may overlap in Gauba, but the arguments should not be treated as interchangeable. B. Adds a moral dimension and advances a fuller theory of welfare liberalism (Gauba, PDF p.41). C. Liberalism opposes unquestioned and arbitrary authority and demands limits on power plus rights for individuals (Gauba, PDF pp.40-41). D. on this view, forced or compulsory redistribution (tax-financed welfare, state intervention) is itself a form of coercion that curtails freedom without reliably satisfying genuine wants, even when it is intended to enlarge welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Liberalism vs authoritarianism** with **Liberalism opposes unquestioned and arbitrary authority and demands limits on power plus rights for individuals (Gauba, PDF pp.40-41).**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Liberalism opposes unquestioned and arbitrary authority and demands limits on power plus rights for individuals (Gauba, PDF pp.40-41).**

A. "Examine"/"Critically examine" B. Welfare / positive liberalism C. Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism D. Liberalism vs authoritarianism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Liberalism opposes unquestioned and arbitrary authority and demands limits on power plus rights for individuals (Gauba, PDF pp.40-41).** with **Liberalism vs authoritarianism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Classical vs welfare liberalism**?

A. Classical liberalism wants minimal state interference; welfare liberalism wants positive state action for dignity and welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42). B. Father of liberalism; early defender of rights, consent and limited government within classical liberalism (Gauba, PDF p.41). C. Develop the welfare-state tradition in the first half of the twentieth century (Gauba, PDF p.41). D. Test Hayek's knowledge/price/coercion arguments (§13) and Nozick's entitlement theory (§14) against the Rawlsian/welfare reply (§15).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Classical vs welfare liberalism** with **Classical liberalism wants minimal state interference; welfare liberalism wants positive state action for dignity and welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Classical liberalism wants minimal state interference; welfare liberalism wants positive state action for dignity and welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).**

A. "Critically evaluate" B. Classical vs welfare liberalism C. Welfare state D. Individualism vs utilitarianism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Classical liberalism wants minimal state interference; welfare liberalism wants positive state action for dignity and welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).** with **Classical vs welfare liberalism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism**?

A. Early liberal defender of laissez-faire and market society (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42). B. Chief exponents of neoliberal or libertarian rollback against the welfare state (Gauba, PDF p.42). C. Welfare liberalism expands state responsibility; neoliberalism wants to roll back intervention and restore laissez-faire individualism (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43). D. Give a reasoned verdict on whether liberalism's economic program (classical vs welfare vs neoliberal) or its constitutional core (§9, §19 Unit 6) is its more defensible contribution.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism** with **Welfare liberalism expands state responsibility; neoliberalism wants to roll back intervention and restore laissez-faire individualism (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Welfare liberalism expands state responsibility; neoliberalism wants to roll back intervention and restore laissez-faire individualism (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).**

A. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20) B. Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism C. Capitalism vs constitutionalism D. Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Welfare liberalism expands state responsibility; neoliberalism wants to roll back intervention and restore laissez-faire individualism (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).** with **Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Individualism vs utilitarianism**?

A. Early liberal thought develops both through rights-bearing individualism and through happiness-maximizing utilitarianism, though Mill pulls utilitarianism toward liberty and welfare reform (Gauba, PDF p.42). B. Founder of utilitarianism, focused on greatest happiness, but still part of early liberal development (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42). C. neoliberalism holds that governments cannot possess sufficient knowledge of dispersed individual needs and circumstances to plan an economy successfully; needs and coordination emerge instead through unpredictable transactions in a free market ("spontaneous order"), not through centralized state knowledge (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43). D. Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (§21).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Individualism vs utilitarianism** with **Early liberal thought develops both through rights-bearing individualism and through happiness-maximizing utilitarianism, though Mill pulls utilitarianism toward liberty and welfare reform (Gauba, PDF p.42).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Early liberal thought develops both through rights-bearing individualism and through happiness-maximizing utilitarianism, though Mill pulls utilitarianism toward liberty and welfare reform (Gauba, PDF p.42).**

A. Authoritarian state B. Individualism vs utilitarianism C. Liberalism vs authoritarianism D. Neoliberalism vs libertarianism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Early liberal thought develops both through rights-bearing individualism and through happiness-maximizing utilitarianism, though Mill pulls utilitarianism toward liberty and welfare reform (Gauba, PDF p.42).** with **Individualism vs utilitarianism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Capitalism vs constitutionalism**?

A. Modifies utilitarianism, elevates liberty, and opens the road toward taxation for welfare and a positive state role (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42). B. the neoliberal claim is that decentralized market exchange coordinates dispersed knowledge and choices more effectively than central planning, and Gauba reports the further neoliberal claim that markets maximize choice and can even serve as a model of genuine "democracy" in the economic sphere (Gauba, PDF p.43). C. Gauba says liberalism today is invoked both as a theory of capitalism and as a theory of constitutionalism; the second has more lasting political value (Gauba, PDF p.45). D. A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge (Gauba, PDF p.40).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Capitalism vs constitutionalism** with **Gauba says liberalism today is invoked both as a theory of capitalism and as a theory of constitutionalism; the second has more lasting political value (Gaub, PDF p.45)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gaub says liberalism today is invoked both as a theory of capitalism and as a theory of constitutionalism; the second has more lasting political value (Gaub, PDF p.45)**.

A. Classical / negative liberalism B. Classical vs welfare liberalism C. John Locke D. Capitalism vs constitutionalism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gaub says liberalism today is invoked both as a theory of capitalism and as a theory of constitutionalism; the second has more lasting political value (Gaub, PDF p.45)**, with **Capitalism vs constitutionalism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Neoliberalism vs libertarianism**?

A. Hayek and Friedman chiefly defend market coordination and limits on welfare intervention; Nozick grounds a minimal state in self-ownership and entitlement. The labels may overlap in Gauba, but the arguments should not be treated as interchangeable. B. Adds a moral dimension and advances a fuller theory of welfare liberalism (Gaub, PDF p.41). C. on this view, forced or compulsory redistribution (tax-financed welfare, state intervention) is itself a form of coercion that curtails freedom without reliably satisfying genuine wants, even when it is intended to enlarge welfare (Gaub, PDF pp.42-43). D. The laissez-faire strand that confines the state to protection of life, property, contract and minimal common services (Gaub, PDF p.41).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Neoliberalism vs libertarianism** with **Hayek and Friedman chiefly defend market coordination and limits on welfare intervention; Nozick grounds a minimal state in self-ownership and entitlement. The labels may overlap in Gauba, but the arguments should not be treated as interchangeable**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Hayek and Friedman chiefly defend market coordination and limits on welfare intervention; Nozick grounds a minimal state in self-ownership and entitlement. The labels may overlap in Gauba, but the arguments should not be treated as interchangeable**.

A. Welfare / positive liberalism B. Neoliberalism vs libertarianism C. Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism D. Adam Smith

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Hayek and Friedman chiefly defend market coordination and limits on welfare intervention; Nozick grounds a minimal state in self-ownership and entitlement. The labels may overlap in Gauba, but the arguments should not be treated as interchangeable**, with **Neoliberalism vs libertarianism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **John Locke**?

A. Develop the welfare-state tradition in the first half of the twentieth century (Gaub, PDF p.41). B. Test Hayek's knowledge/price/coercion arguments (§13) and Nozick's entitlement theory (§14) against the Rawlsian/welfare reply (§15). C. Father of liberalism; early defender of rights, consent and limited government within classical liberalism

(Gaubu, PDF p.41). D. The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development (Gaubu, PDF p.41).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **John Locke** with **Father of liberalism; early defender of rights, consent and limited government within classical liberalism (Gaubu, PDF p.41)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Father of liberalism; early defender of rights, consent and limited government within classical liberalism (Gaubu, PDF p.41)**.

A. Welfare state B. Individualism vs utilitarianism C. Jeremy Bentham D. John Locke

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Father of liberalism; early defender of rights, consent and limited government within classical liberalism (Gaubu, PDF p.41)** with **John Locke**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Adam Smith**?

A. Early liberal defender of laissez-faire and market society (Gaubu, PDF pp.41-42). B. Chief exponents of neoliberal or libertarian rollback against the welfare state (Gaubu, PDF p.42). C. Give a reasoned verdict on whether liberalism's economic program (classical vs welfare vs neoliberal) or its constitutional core (§9, §19 Unit 6) is its more defensible contribution. D. A state that provides social security, education, health and other public services to secure social well-being (Gaubu, PDF p.41).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Adam Smith** with **Early liberal defender of laissez-faire and market society (Gaubu, PDF pp.41-42)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Early liberal defender of laissez-faire and market society (Gaubu, PDF pp.41-42)**.

A. Neoliberalism / neo-classical liberalism / libertarianism B. Adam Smith C. Capitalism vs constitutionalism D. J.S. Mill

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Early liberal defender of laissez-faire and market society (Gaubu, PDF pp.41-42)** with **Adam Smith**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Jeremy Bentham**?

A. neoliberalism holds that governments cannot possess sufficient knowledge of dispersed individual needs and circumstances to plan an economy successfully; needs and coordination emerge instead through unpredictable transactions in a free market ("spontaneous order"), not through centralized state knowledge (Gaubu, PDF pp.42-43). B. Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (§21). C. Founder of utilitarianism, focused on greatest happiness, but still part of early liberal development (Gaubu, PDF pp.41-42). D. Gaubu groups these closely as a restoration of laissez-faire and welfare-state rollback (Gaubu, PDF pp.42-43). For conceptual precision, market neoliberalism (Hayek/Friedman) and rights-based libertarianism (Nozick) overlap but are not identical.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Jeremy Bentham** with **Founder of utilitarianism, focused on greatest happiness, but still part of early liberal development (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Founder of utilitarianism, focused on greatest happiness, but still part of early liberal development (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42)**.

A. Liberalism vs authoritarianism B. Neoliberalism vs libertarianism C. T.H. Green D. Jeremy Bentham

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Founder of utilitarianism, focused on greatest happiness, but still part of early liberal development (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42)** with **Jeremy Bentham**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **J.S. Mill**?

A. Modifies utilitarianism, elevates liberty, and opens the road toward taxation for welfare and a positive state role (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42). B. the neoliberal claim is that decentralized market exchange coordinates dispersed knowledge and choices more effectively than central planning, and Gaub reports the further neoliberal claim that markets maximize choice and can even serve as a model of genuine "democracy" in the economic sphere (Gaub, PDF p.43). C. A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge (Gaub, PDF p.40). D. Liberalism opposes unquestioned and arbitrary authority and demands limits on power plus rights for individuals (Gaub, PDF pp.40-41).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **J.S. Mill** with **Modifies utilitarianism, elevates liberty, and opens the road toward taxation for welfare and a positive state role (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Modifies utilitarianism, elevates liberty, and opens the road toward taxation for welfare and a positive state role (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42)**.

A. Classical vs welfare liberalism B. J.S. Mill C. John Locke D. Hobhouse / Laski / Tawney

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Modifies utilitarianism, elevates liberty, and opens the road toward taxation for welfare and a positive state role (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42)** with **J.S. Mill**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **T.H. Green**?

A. on this view, forced or compulsory redistribution (tax-financed welfare, state intervention) is itself a form of coercion that curtails freedom without reliably satisfying genuine wants, even when it is intended to enlarge welfare (Gaub, PDF pp.42-43). B. The laissez-faire strand that confines the state to protection of life, property, contract and minimal common services (Gaub, PDF p.41). C. Adds a moral dimension and advances a fuller theory of welfare liberalism (Gaub, PDF p.41). D. Classical liberalism wants minimal state interference; welfare liberalism wants positive state action for dignity and welfare (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **T.H. Green** with **Adds a moral dimension and advances a fuller theory of welfare liberalism (Gaub, PDF p.41)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong

to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Adds a moral dimension and advances a fuller theory of welfare liberalism (Gauba, PDF p.41).**

A. Welfare liberalism vs neoliberalism B. Adam Smith C. Hayek / Friedman / Nozick D. T.H. Green

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Adds a moral dimension and advances a fuller theory of welfare liberalism (Gauba, PDF p.41).** with **T.H. Green**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Hobhouse / Laski / Tawney**?

A. Develop the welfare-state tradition in the first half of the twentieth century (Gauba, PDF p.41). B. Test Hayek's knowledge/price/coercion arguments (§13) and Nozick's entitlement theory (§14) against the Rawlsian/welfare reply (§15). C. The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development (Gauba, PDF p.41). D. Welfare liberalism expands state responsibility; neoliberalism wants to roll back intervention and restore laissez-faire individualism (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Hobhouse / Laski / Tawney** with **Develop the welfare-state tradition in the first half of the twentieth century (Gauba, PDF p.41).**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Develop the welfare-state tradition in the first half of the twentieth century (Gauba, PDF p.41).**

A. Individualism vs utilitarianism B. Hobhouse / Laski / Tawney C. Jeremy Bentham D. Knowledge argument

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Develop the welfare-state tradition in the first half of the twentieth century (Gauba, PDF p.41).** with **Hobhouse / Laski / Tawney**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Hayek / Friedman / Nozick**?

A. Give a reasoned verdict on whether liberalism's economic program (classical vs welfare vs neoliberal) or its constitutional core (§9, §19 Unit 6) is its more defensible contribution. B. A state that provides social security, education, health and other public services to secure social well-being (Gauba, PDF p.41). C. Chief exponents of neoliberal or libertarian rollback against the welfare state (Gauba, PDF p.42). D. Early liberal thought develops both through rights-bearing individualism and through happiness-maximizing utilitarianism, though Mill pulls utilitarianism toward liberty and welfare reform (Gauba, PDF p.42).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Hayek / Friedman / Nozick** with **Chief exponents of neoliberal or libertarian rollback against the welfare state (Gauba, PDF p.42).**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Chief exponents of neoliberal or libertarian rollback against the welfare state (Gauba, PDF p.42).**

A. Capitalism vs constitutionalism B. J.S. Mill C. Price/market-coordination argument D. Hayek / Friedman / Nozick

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Chief exponents of neoliberal or libertarian rollback against the welfare state (Gauba, PDF p.42)**. with **Hayek / Friedman / Nozick**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Knowledge argument**?

A. neoliberalism holds that governments cannot possess sufficient knowledge of dispersed individual needs and circumstances to plan an economy successfully; needs and coordination emerge instead through unpredictable transactions in a free market ("spontaneous order"), not through centralized state knowledge (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43). B. Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (§21). C. Gauba groups these closely as a restoration of laissez-faire and welfare-state rollback (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43). For conceptual precision, market neoliberalism (Hayek/Friedman) and rights-based libertarianism (Nozick) overlap but are not identical. D. Gauba says liberalism today is invoked both as a theory of capitalism and as a theory of constitutionalism; the second has more lasting political value (Gauba, PDF p.45).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Knowledge argument** with **neoliberalism holds that governments cannot possess sufficient knowledge of dispersed individual needs and circumstances to plan an economy successfully; needs and coordination emerge instead through unpredictable transactions in a free market ("spontaneous order")**, not through centralized state knowledge (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **neoliberalism holds that governments cannot possess sufficient knowledge of dispersed individual needs and circumstances to plan an economy successfully; needs and coordination emerge instead through unpredictable transactions in a free market ("spontaneous order")**, not through centralized state knowledge (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).

A. Neoliberalism vs libertarianism B. Knowledge argument C. T.H. Green D. Coercion argument

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **neoliberalism holds that governments cannot possess sufficient knowledge of dispersed individual needs and circumstances to plan an economy successfully; needs and coordination emerge instead through unpredictable transactions in a free market ("spontaneous order")**, not through centralized state knowledge (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43). with **Knowledge argument**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Price/market-coordination argument**?

A. A state in which authority is treated as unquestionable and its directives must be obeyed without challenge (Gauba, PDF p.40). B. Liberalism opposes unquestioned and arbitrary authority and demands limits on power plus rights for individuals (Gauba, PDF pp.40-41). C. the neoliberal claim is that decentralized market exchange coordinates dispersed knowledge and choices more effectively than central planning, and Gauba reports the further neoliberal claim that markets maximize choice and can even serve as a model of genuine "democracy" in the economic sphere (Gauba, PDF p.43). D. Hayek and Friedman chiefly defend market coordination and limits on welfare intervention; Nozick grounds a minimal state in self-ownership and entitlement. The labels may overlap in Gauba, but the arguments should not be treated as interchangeable.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Price/market-coordination argument** with **the neoliberal claim is that decentralized market exchange coordinates dispersed knowledge and choices more effectively than**

central planning, and Gauba reports the further neoliberal claim that markets maximize choice and can even serve as a model of genuine "democracy" in the economic sphere (Gauba, PDF p.43).. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the neoliberal claim is that decentralized market exchange coordinates dispersed knowledge and choices more effectively than central planning, and Gauba reports the further neoliberal claim that markets maximize choice and can even serve as a model of genuine "democracy" in the economic sphere (Gauba, PDF p.43).**

A. John Locke B. Hobhouse / Laski / Tawney C. "Examine"/"Critically examine" D. Price/market-coordination argument

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the neoliberal claim is that decentralized market exchange coordinates dispersed knowledge and choices more effectively than central planning, and Gauba reports the further neoliberal claim that markets maximize choice and can even serve as a model of genuine "democracy" in the economic sphere (Gauba, PDF p.43).** with **Price/market-coordination argument**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Coercion argument**?

A. on this view, forced or compulsory redistribution (tax-financed welfare, state intervention) is itself a form of coercion that curtails freedom without reliably satisfying genuine wants, even when it is intended to enlarge welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43). B. The laissez-faire strand that confines the state to protection of life, property, contract and minimal common services (Gauba, PDF p.41). C. Classical liberalism wants minimal state interference; welfare liberalism wants positive state action for dignity and welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42). D. Father of liberalism; early defender of rights, consent and limited government within classical liberalism (Gauba, PDF p.41).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Coercion argument** with **on this view, forced or compulsory redistribution (tax-financed welfare, state intervention) is itself a form of coercion that curtails freedom without reliably satisfying genuine wants, even when it is intended to enlarge welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **on this view, forced or compulsory redistribution (tax-financed welfare, state intervention) is itself a form of coercion that curtails freedom without reliably satisfying genuine wants, even when it is intended to enlarge welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).**

A. Adam Smith B. Coercion argument C. Hayek / Friedman / Nozick D. "Critically evaluate"

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **on this view, forced or compulsory redistribution (tax-financed welfare, state intervention) is itself a form of coercion that curtails freedom without reliably satisfying genuine wants, even when it is intended to enlarge welfare (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43).** with **Coercion argument**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **"Examine"/"Critically examine"**?

A. The strand that gives the state a positive role in securing a dignified life, welfare and self-development (Gauba, PDF p.41). B. Welfare liberalism expands state responsibility; neoliberalism wants to roll back intervention and restore laissez-faire individualism (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43). C. Test Hayek's knowledge/price/coercion arguments (§13) and

Nozick's entitlement theory (§14) against the Rawlsian/welfare reply (§15). D. Early liberal defender of laissez-faire and market society (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **"Examine"/"Critically examine"** with **Test Hayek's knowledge/price/coercion arguments (§13) and Nozick's entitlement theory (§14) against the Rawlsian/welfare reply (§15)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Test Hayek's knowledge/price/coercion arguments (§13) and Nozick's entitlement theory (§14) against the Rawlsian/welfare reply (§15)**.

A. Jeremy Bentham B. Knowledge argument C. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20) D. "Examine"/"Critically examine"

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Test Hayek's knowledge/price/coercion arguments (§13) and Nozick's entitlement theory (§14) against the Rawlsian/welfare reply (§15)** with **"Examine"/"Critically examine"**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **"Critically evaluate"**?

A. Give a reasoned verdict on whether liberalism's economic program (classical vs welfare vs neoliberal) or its constitutional core (§9, §19 Unit 6) is its more defensible contribution. B. A state that provides social security, education, health and other public services to secure social well-being (Gauba, PDF p.41). C. Early liberal thought develops both through rights-bearing individualism and through happiness-maximizing utilitarianism, though Mill pulls utilitarianism toward liberty and welfare reform (Gauba, PDF p.42). D. Founder of utilitarianism, focused on greatest happiness, but still part of early liberal development (Gauba, PDF pp.41-42).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **"Critically evaluate"** with **Give a reasoned verdict on whether liberalism's economic program (classical vs welfare vs neoliberal) or its constitutional core (§9, §19 Unit 6) is its more defensible contribution**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Give a reasoned verdict on whether liberalism's economic program (classical vs welfare vs neoliberal) or its constitutional core (§9, §19 Unit 6) is its more defensible contribution**.

A. J.S. Mill B. "Critically evaluate" C. Price/market-coordination argument D. Authoritarian state

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Give a reasoned verdict on whether liberalism's economic program (classical vs welfare vs neoliberal) or its constitutional core (§9, §19 Unit 6) is its more defensible contribution** with **"Critically evaluate"**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Mark-weight cue (10/15/20)**?

A. Gauba groups these closely as a restoration of laissez-faire and welfare-state rollback (Gauba, PDF pp.42-43). For conceptual precision, market neoliberalism (Hayek/Friedman) and rights-based libertarianism (Nozick) overlap but are not identical. B. Gauba says liberalism today is invoked both as a theory of capitalism and as a theory of constitutionalism; the second has more lasting political value (Gauba, PDF p.45). C. Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (§21). D. Modifies utilitarianism, elevates liberty, and opens the road toward taxation for

welfare and a positive state role (Gaub, PDF pp.41-42).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mark-weight cue (10/15/20)** with **Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (§21)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (§21)**.

A. T.H. Green B. Coercion argument C. Classical / negative liberalism D. Mark-weight cue (10/15/20)

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (§21)** with **Mark-weight cue (10/15/20)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Cross-application ownership note: These are verified Philosophy Optional questions whose primary owner is Social and Political Ideals. They are not re-routed to Political Theory; they are included because this topic provides a directly usable supporting framework.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2021 Q1(a), 10 marks

Question: Discuss critically the distributive theory of justice as propounded by R. Nozick.

Model solution

Thesis. Nozick's is a HISTORICAL (entitlement) theory, not a distributive one in the patterned sense: a distribution is just if it arose through just steps, whatever its final shape. Powerful as a warning, it is incomplete on its own premises.

- **Doctrine.** Justice in holdings has three principles -- justice in ACQUISITION

(how unowned things are first justly held), justice in TRANSFER (voluntary exchange and gift) and justice in RECTIFICATION (correcting past injustice). There is no required end-state pattern.

- **Historical vs patterned.** Patterned principles (equality, need, merit) judge

the shape of the distribution; historical principles judge the PROCESS. The Wilt Chamberlain argument shows that if people freely pay to watch him, the resulting inequality is just, and maintaining any fixed pattern would require continuous interference with voluntary transfers.

- **Critique.** The acquisition and rectification principles are the weakest

links: both need an independent criterion, and real starting distributions are tainted by conquest, coercion and background injustice, so "voluntariness" is rarely clean.

Verdict. Nozick's side-constraint, self-ownership warning against overreaching redistribution is a permanent contribution; but because his own foundational principles are under-specified, entitlement theory cannot bypass the problem of unjust starting points.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it fixes the historical/patterned distinction, uses Wilt Chamberlain as argument (not decoration), and lands the critique on acquisition/rectification.

Solved PYQ 13 - 2025 Q1(e), 10 marks

Question: Discuss the salient features of equality according to J.S. Mill.

Model solution

Thesis. Mill is a QUALIFIED liberal egalitarian: he affirms equal moral and civic standing -- above all women's equality -- while resisting a crude levelling that would suppress individuality.

- **Salient features.** (1) Equal moral worth -- each person counts, none discounted by birth. (2) Equality before law and citizenship -- privilege by status is indefensible. (3) WOMEN'S equality -- in The Subjection of Women the legal and social subordination of women is a relic of domination, not nature. (4) Equality compatible with INDIVIDUALITY -- sameness is not the goal, free self-development is. (5) Hostility to custom-made hierarchy. (6) A qualified economic concern -- open to reforming property and labour relations, not to coercive levelling.

- **The core argument.** A society that excludes half its members or attaches rights to status wastes human capacities and violates utility properly understood; the "nature" invoked to justify subordination is itself socially manufactured through subjection.

- **Limit.** Mill remains too individualist to reach structural economic inequality -- but within liberalism he radicalises equality by extending it from formal rights to social relations, especially gender.

Verdict. Mill's equality is equality of STATUS, RIGHTS and CHANCE compatible with liberty and individuality -- egalitarian in worth and gender, restrained in economics.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it lists Mill's features precisely, foregrounds the feminist argument and the individuality proviso, and states the structural limit rather than over-claiming.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish classical liberalism, welfare liberalism and neoliberalism. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: The three strands share commitment to the individual, rights and constitutional restraint, but differ over the conditions required for effective freedom.

Core analysis: Classical liberalism stresses negative liberty, private property, contract and a limited state that protects rights and market exchange. Welfare or positive liberalism argues that formal non-interference is insufficient where poverty, ill-health or unequal education prevent real agency; the state must create enabling social conditions. Neoliberalism reasserts market coordination against an established welfare state, using arguments about dispersed knowledge, incentives, coercion and excessive public power. It is therefore a twentieth-century rollback project rather than simply the original classical doctrine.

Critical evaluation: The divisions are not absolute: all three retain constitutionalism, but they disagree sharply about whether public action secures or threatens liberty.

Conclusion: The liberal family is united by individual freedom and constitutional restraint, but divided over whether markets alone secure freedom or an enabling state must create its social conditions.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Explain Hayek's knowledge argument against comprehensive economic planning. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Hayek's central objection to comprehensive planning is that the knowledge needed for social coordination is dispersed, local and often tacit.

Core analysis: No central authority can continuously possess all information about changing preferences, scarcities and opportunities. Competitive prices condense these scattered signals and permit individuals to adjust without a

single commanding mind. Planning that suppresses this process must substitute administrative allocation and increasingly coercive decisions because agreement on one comprehensive hierarchy of ends is absent. Hayek therefore links epistemic limits to spontaneous order and political liberty.

Critical evaluation: The argument establishes a presumption against total planning, not against every public rule or welfare measure. Markets also depend on legal institutions, and externalities or unequal power may require collective correction.

Conclusion: Hayek's strongest case is epistemic rather than merely anti-state: dispersed knowledge limits comprehensive planning, though it does not establish that every public intervention is coercive or irrational.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Critically examine Nozick's entitlement theory and minimal state. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Nozick judges holdings by their history rather than by whether the final distribution fits a preferred pattern.

Core analysis: A holding is entitled when it arises through just acquisition, voluntary transfer and, where injustice occurred, rectification. Since persons possess rights over themselves and legitimately acquired resources, patterned redistribution requires continuous interference with voluntary choices. The legitimate state is therefore minimal, limited to protection against force, theft and fraud and to enforcement of contracts. Nozick's position powerfully exposes the tension between distributive patterns and individual choice.

Further development: The contrast with Rawls clarifies the dispute. Rawls evaluates the basic structure through principles chosen under fair conditions, whereas Nozick rejects end-state patterns that override historical transactions. Nozick protects choice more strongly, but Rawls better explains why institutions must address arbitrary starting positions. A complete assessment should therefore preserve Nozick's warning against continuous interference while rejecting the assumption that actual histories are clean enough for entitlement to operate without substantial rectification.

Critical evaluation: Its difficulty lies in historical injustice and unequal bargaining power. The rectification principle is indispensable but underdeveloped, and existing holdings cannot be presumed just merely because current transfers appear voluntary.

Conclusion: Nozick powerfully protects historical entitlement and individual rights, but rectification and unequal starting conditions prevent the theory from validating every existing distribution.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: How does welfare liberalism answer the classical liberal conception of freedom? Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Welfare liberalism accepts the liberal priority of freedom but rejects the assumption that freedom is exhausted by absence of legal restraint.

Core analysis: Thinkers such as Green and Hobhouse argue that liberty requires the capacity to pursue worthwhile purposes. Laski and Tawney translate this moral insight into institutional claims: education, health, social security and regulation may be needed to prevent dependence and make citizenship effective. The enabling state is therefore justified not as a substitute for individual agency but as a condition of it. This distinguishes positive or substantive freedom from the thinner classical focus on contract and non-interference.

Further development: The internal liberal debate is therefore about the source of unfreedom. Classical liberalism fears coercive law and concentrated public authority; welfare liberalism adds dependence produced by social and

economic deprivation. Green and Hobhouse supply the moral account of enabling freedom, while Laski and Tawney support its institutional expression. The answer remains liberal only if welfare measures protect equal citizenship, legal rights and plural choice rather than allowing an unlimited administrative state.

Critical evaluation: The welfare answer must still confront paternalism, fiscal burden and bureaucratic domination. Public action advances liberty only when it enlarges capabilities while remaining constitutionally accountable.

Conclusion: Welfare liberalism preserves liberty while arguing that formal non-interference is inadequate where poverty, dependence and unequal capability make choice merely nominal.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Evaluate neoliberalism as both a revival of classical liberalism and a response to the welfare state. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Neoliberalism revives classical concerns about state power and market freedom, but it emerges in a different institutional setting.

Core analysis: Like classical liberalism, it values private choice, competition, property and limited government. Unlike the original doctrine, it confronts a mature welfare and regulatory state and therefore seeks rollback, privatisation, deregulation and renewed market discipline. Hayek supplies the knowledge and coercion arguments, Friedman emphasises market coordination, and Nozick offers a rights-based case for the minimal state. These arguments are related but not identical.

Further development: Its three major arguments must remain distinct. Hayek stresses dispersed knowledge and spontaneous order; Friedman stresses market coordination and limits on discretionary government; Nozick stresses self-ownership and historical entitlement. Their convergence supports rollback, but their premises are not interchangeable. Critics respond that market outcomes reflect inherited power and that health, education and social security may enlarge rather than diminish freedom. Constitutional safeguards, competitive institutions and transparent regulation remain necessary even within a market-centred order. The resulting verdict should distinguish a justified presumption for decentralised choice from a dogmatic presumption that every public intervention fails.

Critical evaluation: Neoliberalism correctly identifies information failures and the danger of concentrated public power, yet it can underestimate unequal market power, historical disadvantage and the public institutions on which markets depend.

Conclusion: Neoliberalism revives market liberty, but its distinctive historical target is an already developed welfare state; it is therefore restoration under new conditions, not simple repetition.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Compare the Hayekian, Nozickian and Rawlsian approaches to liberty, property and distributive justice. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Hayek, Nozick and Rawls belong to the liberal family, but they justify institutions through different moral and analytical routes.

Core analysis: Hayek defends spontaneous market order because dispersed knowledge cannot be comprehensively planned; he distrusts distributive designs that treat society as if one agent controlled all outcomes. Nozick begins with self-ownership and historical entitlement, limiting the state to protection and rectification. Rawls asks what principles free and equal persons would choose under fair conditions; equal basic liberties are combined with fair opportunity and the difference principle. Property is therefore constrained by justice as fairness rather than treated as presumptively inviolable.

Further development: The comparison also yields different conceptions of coercion. Hayek fears purposive control of a spontaneous order; Nozick treats compulsory redistribution as a rights violation; Rawls asks whether the coercive basic structure could be justified to citizens as free and equal. Rawls therefore permits redistribution under public principles, Nozick permits only protection and rectification, and Hayek resists distributive language where no single agent designed the outcome. A balanced answer should preserve Hayek's knowledge problem, Nozick's historical test and Rawls's concern with fair background institutions.

Critical evaluation: Hayek's epistemic caution and Nozick's rights protect liberty, while Rawls more directly addresses structural starting points. Each remains vulnerable where its preferred mechanism overlooks the others' concern.

Conclusion: Hayek, Nozick and Rawls defend different moral routes from liberty to institutions, so no serious comparison can collapse spontaneous order, entitlement and fairness into one liberal position.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.